

is also a good choice and may suit those more artistically oriented. But in its present avatar, it is a nightmare to install on Fedora 9/10. Ubuntu users will probably have a better time as www.dvdstyler.de provides *.deb* packages. But back to DeVeDe...

Once you start up DeVeDe, you will be asked about what kind of disc you want to create. Answer 'DVD Video' to that. You will be presented with a screen that looks like what is shown in Figure 1.

In the box (on the left hand side), which says *Titles*, for fun and games, press the *Add* button three or four times. Each time you will find a new title appearing. When you are done clicking, press the *Preview Menu* button (circled in red). What you see will be the first look of what your DVD menu could look like. You will see a background picture and a number of titles corresponding to the number of times that you clicked the *Add* button earlier. Press *OK*.

Of course, the menu right now is incapable of doing anything. You would have to associate your DVD video files with it and surely you would want to name those titles a little more descriptively than *Title 1*, *Title 2*, etc.

To change the default title names, select the title that you want to change and click on the *Properties* button. You will see Figure 2. Change the name to whatever you want to and associate an action with this title by selecting a corresponding option. For a really great touch, you can harness the power of GNU/Linux to write the titles in your mother tongue. I do my titling and credits in Bangla whenever I can.

To make changes to the global menu layout, press the *Menu Options* button (circled in blue). You will then see Figure 3. I could explain what everything here does, but it would be better if you experiment for yourself. Make a change and hit the *Preview Menu* button at the bottom of the window to see what the DVD menu now looks like. You can also have a selected sound file playing in the background when your menu is displayed. Professional stuff! Figure 4 is an example of a DVD menu that could be created.

Now, you would need to associate the video file you want to play when each title is selected. Go back to the window in Figure 1. Select the title you want to associate a video with and press the *Add* button under the *Files* box (which is adjacent to the *Titles* box). Select your video file. Go and click the little triangle beside *Advanced Options*, go to the *Misc* tab and select the checkbox which says "This file is already a DVD/xCD-suitable MPEG-PS file". We are going to do this because we have already used *mencoder* to convert our edited video footage to DVD compatible video.

Once you are done allotting video files to all your titles, you are ready to create the DVD ISO. Click the *Forward* button in the window from Figure 1. You will be asked for a place to store the DVD image. Please heed the warning of not saving to a FAT32 partition. A

FAT32 cannot store any file over 4 GB (a DVD image can be as large as 4.3 GB) and all kinds of horrible things will happen. (*Lesson: Avoid anything even remotely connected to the Windows world:-)*)

When DeVeDe is finished with the process you will find an ISO with whatever name you selected, saved at whatever directory you chose. (I am assuming that you have kept the default options from Figure 1.)

Burn, baby burn!

You are a step away from sweeping friends and family off their feet. Fire up K3b. If it is not already on your system, Yum is your best friend. Select *Tools* → *Burn DVD ISO Image...*

The rest is easy. You can play back this DVD on a standalone player.

Afterthoughts

Before I leave you with dreams of your movie, let me point out some things that you could explore further.

Kino is capable of Firewire capture, so if you have a Firewire port and a similarly enabled video camera, you could get your footage straight from your camera to Kino.

DVD compatible video can be created through Kino and DeVeDe as well. I'll leave that exercise to you, if you haven't noticed it already. In essence, it uses *mencoder* commands in the background that are very similar to the ones that I have written about. In addition, DeVeDe can encode to XviD as well.

DeVeDe also allows you to create a VCD, as does K3b. While DeVeDe can encode to VCD compatible video, you'll have to manually do the encoding for K3b with *mencoder* from the command line. In *K3b*, select *Further Actions...* in the *Quickstart* tab you can select *New Video CD Project*.

DVDStyler allows you to customise your menu item graphics and also allows you to place them anywhere on the DVD menu screen.

I am hoping that this article will take you a step closer to completely shifting to GNU/Linux. For the last eight years, I have had no OS but Fedora on my desktop. And I am an average (but dedicated) GNU/Linux user.

Last but not least, while I have done some experimentation, I have learnt about a lot of the material presented here from sources on the Web. I am afraid I cannot acknowledge everyone because I keep all these commands in a text file in my home directory, and have no idea where I collected them from. But rest assured, it wouldn't have been possible without the great Open Source Community. 

By: Anurup Mitra

The author is a long-time Fedora fan(atic) and GNU/Linux lover and wants to see Linux on every computer in India. He works for STMicroelectronics and divides his time between designing circuits for them and teaching at BITS Pilani. He can be reached at anurup.mitra@gmail.com